



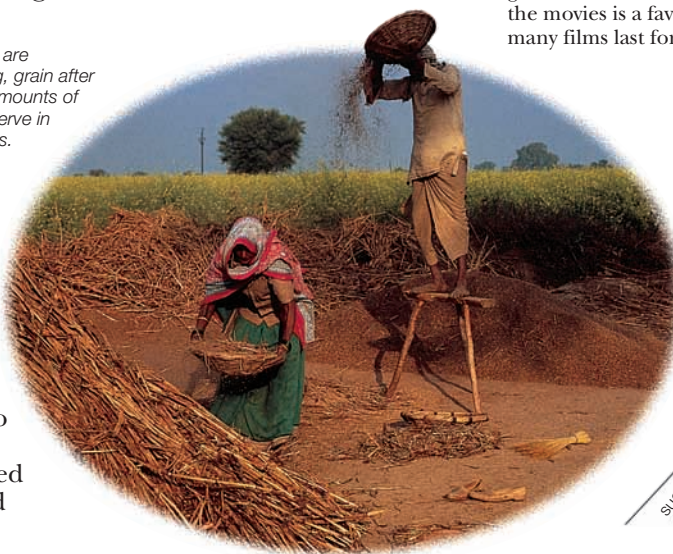
INDIA

Capital city: New Delhi**Area:** 1,269,338 sq miles (3,287,590 sq km)**Population:** 1,070,000,000**Official languages:** Hindi, English**Major religions:** Hindu 83%, Muslim 11%, Christian 2%, Sikh 2%, other 2%**Government:** Multiparty democracy**Currency:** Rupee**Adult literacy rate:** 61%**Life expectancy:** 63 years**People per doctor:** 1,885**Televisions:** 69 per 1,000 people

INDIA

THE WORLD'S SEVENTH LARGEST and second most populated country, India is a vast, colorful land, full of variety in religion, language, and culture. Three of the world's major faiths, Hinduism, Buddhism, and Sikhism, originated here. More than 200 languages are spoken, although 40 percent of the population speaks Hindi. Despite much poverty, India is one of the world's top industrialized nations. Both agriculture and industry have expanded during the past 20 years and have attracted investment from international companies. India is also the world's largest democracy. Some 600 million people are eligible to vote.

These farm workers are winnowing, or sifting, grain after the harvest. Huge amounts of grain are kept in reserve in case the harvest fails.



BOLLYWOOD

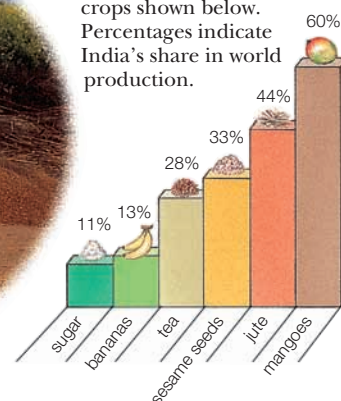
More films are produced in India than anywhere else in the world, including the US. About 800 full-length feature films are shot each year, mainly in Mumbai (Bombay), nicknamed "Bollywood." Indian films are often packed with songs, dancing, romance, glamorous stars, and nonstop action. Going to the movies is a favorite pastime in India, and many films last for four or five hours.

GREEN REVOLUTION

One of India's most pressing problems has been to produce enough food for its ever-growing population. Today, it is self-sufficient in food. Production of rice and wheat has risen more than 200 percent since independence in 1947. This improvement is partly due to the "Green Revolution" of the 1960s, when farming methods were modernized and higher-yielding varieties of rice and wheat were planted.

FOOD PRODUCTION

India is the world's biggest producer of the crops shown below. Percentages indicate India's share in world production.



Cinnamon is used in both sweet and savory dishes.



Coriander is an essential ingredient in many Indian dishes.



Garlic is added to many spice mixtures.



Turmeric is used as a spice and a dye.



INDIAN FOOD

Many Indian people are vegetarians. They do not believe in killing animals to eat. Most Hindus never eat beef because they consider cows to be sacred, and Muslims do not eat pork. Food varies from place to place, but a typical meal might consist of several spicy vegetable dishes, *dhal* (lentils), *dahi* (yogurt), rice or *chappatis* (flat bread), and *poppadums*. The food is flavored with many spices, including turmeric, chili, coriander, cumin, and cardamom.

Rice



Vegetables in a spicy sauce



INDUSTRY

Since independence, industry has expanded in India. Factories produce and process goods such as cars, chemicals, food and beverages, and computers. Jet airplanes and space rockets are now being made. Textiles and leather goods are major exports. Traditionally, much of India's industrial output has come from small, family-run industries producing traditional handicrafts such as brasswork, mirror work, and tie dye.